

Nephelis Industries

Project AETHER — The Venus Cloud Platform

Tagline: Build life in the clouds of Venus.

Executive Summary

Thesis: Venus’s cloud layer (50–55 km) offers Earth-like pressure, temp, and gravity (~0.9 g) — uniquely suited for long-term human/AI ops. **Wedge:** Project AETHER: \$500k aerostat probe (Cloudseeker) + cubesat relay to generate first-party data and de-risk habitats. **Why now:** Rideshare costs down, Venus astrobiology resurgence, community-driven funding model. **Business model:** Near-term sponsorship + DNA capsules; Mid-term data/IP licensing; Long-term habitats/tourism. **Ask:** \$500k seed for build/test/launch.

Business Case & Monetization

Venus offers 1.9× Earth’s solar energy, abundant CO₂/N₂ resources, and faster transit (~146 days). Initial revenue: personalized sponsorships (messages/logos, DNA capsules). Long-term: Data/IP licensing, tourism, and resource sales.

Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Milestones
Phase 1	2025–27	Fund/launch Cloudseeker; build community
Phase 2	2028–30	VenusExpress fast transit; partner with SpaceX/NASA
Phase 3	2030+	Habitats; luxury tourism; ISRU

Competitive Edge

Government missions (DAVINCI, VERITAS) focus on science. Nephelis targets colonization readiness. Adjacent private efforts (Rocket Lab) focus on astrobiology; we specialize in materials, comms, and operations with sponsor-driven funding.

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